Organization (MSSO) with the help of various regulators and the Japanese Maintenance Organization (JMO) maintain all translations of MedDRA to ensure consistency, inclusion of new medical concepts, and quality. Unlike some other terminologies, there are no regional extensions of MedDRA. There is only one version of MedDRA in all languages. This makes full interoperability between languages possible. This feature facilitates many important uses of MedDRA, including electronic data exchange, reproducibility of search results and communication between/among: industry and regulators; industry partners; and regulatory partners. In addition the multilingual approach allows most users to operate in their native language and that promotes accuracy and precision in assigning codes.

Each term at every level is assigned a unique 8 digit numeric code. When information is exchanged the unique numeric code for a MedDRA term is used. This code is the key to the translations. To demonstrate this, the following table shows the code and its meaning in English and Japanese for several clinical concepts.

Preferred Term Code		English		Japanese
10022000	=	Influenza	=	インフルエンザ
10047470	=	Viral myocarditis	=	ウイルス性心筋炎
10027599	=	Migraine	=	片頭痛

Thus, the PT code 10022000 always represents the clinical concept of “influenza”, no matter the language used. Therefore, an English user can assign the code and a Japanese user (for example) would understand the same clinical concept, even though neither user is likely fluent in the other’s language.

Because of the way MedDRA is constructed and maintained, interoperability is possible, making MedDRA, when combined with electronic data exchange, an extremely powerful tool.

FACTSHEET

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- A multilingual access welcome page on the MedDRA website.

Slovak Slovenian Spanish Swedish

All release documents are updated with each new version of MedDRA using rules designed to ensure consistency within and amongst translations and can be found on the MedDRA website.

Users can also submit change requests to propose update to the translation of any translated versions of MedDRA. A variety of training sessions and videocasts are also available in several different languages.

transferred to ICH, the MSSO would maintain the new languages and assure coordination of updates with all other translations.

Interest in a new language can be raised to the MedDRA Secretariat for the attention of the Committee.

About ICH

MedDRA is a product of the International Council for Harmonisation of Technical Requirements for Pharmaceuticals for Human Use (ICH). ICH brings together the regulatory authorities and pharmaceutical industry to standardise and streamline scientific and technical aspects of the drug regulatory process.

Useful Links

MedDRA Website: www.meddra.org
MSSO Help Desk: mssohelp@meddra.org
JMO Help Desk: helpdesk.jmo@pmrj.jp
MedDRA Secretariat: admin@ich.org